

TOPIC 8: HUMAN TRAFFICKING

1. Meaning of Human Trafficking

Human trafficking is the recruitment, transportation, transfer, harbouring or receipt of persons by threat, force, coercion, abduction, fraud or deception for the purpose of exploitation. Exploitation includes forced labour, sexual exploitation, forced begging and other forms of abuse. It is a serious crime and a violation of human rights.

2. Causes

- Poverty and lack of opportunity
- Unemployment and desire for a better life abroad or in cities
- Conflict, instability and family breakdown
- Deception by traffickers (false job or education offers)
- Weak law enforcement and corruption
- Demand for cheap labour or commercial sex

3. Consequences

- Physical and sexual abuse, disease, injury and death
- Mental trauma, depression and loss of self-worth
- Loss of education and future opportunities
- Separation from family and community
- Harm to national image and security

4. Prevention

- Education and awareness about the tactics of traffickers
- Poverty reduction and creation of real opportunities
- Strong laws and effective prosecution of traffickers
- Protection and support for victims (shelter, counselling, reintegration)
- Reporting suspicious activity to authorities (e.g. NAPTIP in Nigeria)
- Community and family vigilance

5. Summary

Human trafficking is modern-day slavery. Understanding its causes and consequences helps prevention. Education, opportunity, law enforcement and care for victims are key responses.

End of Topic 8 – Human Trafficking

— End of JSS 2 Social and Citizenship Studies First Term Notes —